**Strong 2-♣ Opening**

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠4

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥6

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♦
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠K

***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A J 10 5<br>♥ 8 5<br>♦ Q 7 2<br>♣ K Q 5 3 | |
| ♠ 9 6 4 2<br>♥ 9 7 4<br>♦ 10 5 3<br>♣ A 9 7 |  | ♠ 3<br>♥ J 10 6 3<br>♦ 9 8 4<br>♣ J 10 8 4 2 |
| | ♠ K Q 8 7<br>♥ A K Q 2<br>♦ A K J 6<br>♣ 6 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 3♣ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4♠ |
| Pass | 6♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

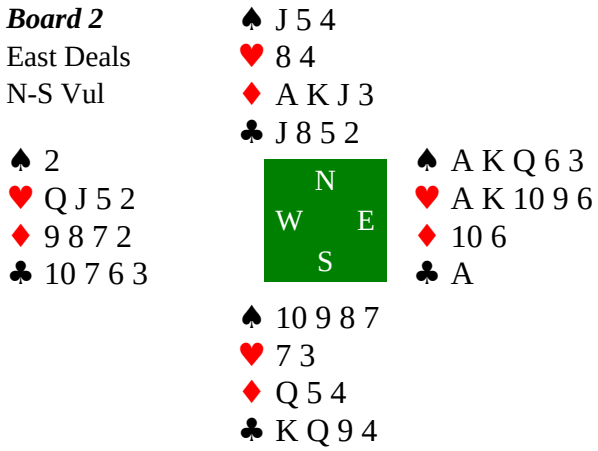
6♠ by North
Lead: ♣J

After SOUTH's 2♣ opening, NORTH bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. NORTH actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

SOUTH's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking NORTH for a 4-card Major. NORTH mentions his ♠s and SOUTH bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now NORTH adds his 12 points to SOUTH's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

***Board 2***
East Deals
N-S Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 2♣ | Pass |
| 2♦ | Pass | 2♠ | Pass |
| 3♣ | Pass | 3♥ | Pass |
| 4♥ | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

4♥ by East
Lead: ♥3

WEST has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to EAST's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when EAST bids 2♠.

However, when EAST then bids ♥s, WEST finds two more points and bids 4♥.

***Board 3***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 5
♥ A K 6
♦ A K 8
♣ K Q J

♠ 7 4 3
♥ 8 3 2
♦ J 6 5 4 3
♣ A 9




♠ A 9 6
♥ J 10 9 4
♦ 9
♣ 10 8 6 4 2

♠ K J 2
♥ Q 7 5
♦ Q 10 7 2
♣ 7 5 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2NT |
| Pass | 3NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

3NT by South
Lead: ♠4

NORTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But SOUTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so NORTH must adapt. She shows her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since NORTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

***Board 4***
West Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 6 5 4<br>♥ 9 4<br>♦ A J 10 2<br>♣ K Q 5 2 | |
| ♠ A Q J 2<br>♥ A K 5<br>♦ K Q 7 3<br>♣ A 6 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ K 9 8 7<br>♥ Q J 8 2<br>♦ 9 8 6<br>♣ 7 4 |
| | ♠ 10 3<br>♥ 10 7 6 3<br>♦ 5 4<br>♣ J 10 9 8 3 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2♣ | Pass | 2♦ | Pass |
| 2NT | Pass | 3♣ | Pass |
| 3♠ | Pass | 4♠ | |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by West
Lead: ♠4

WEST has a balanced 23-point hand. He opens 2♣.

With 6 points and two 4-card Majors, EAST can only say 2♦.

WEST shows his minimum hand with a 2NT rebid.

Now EAST bids 3♣. This is not the second negative, but rather it is Stayman.

When WEST shows his ♠ suit EAST bids 4♠.

***Board 5***
South Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K 7 2<br>♥ A 9 7 5<br>♦ 10 7 2<br>♣ A 5 3 | |
| ♠ Q J 10<br>♥ J 8 2<br>♦ 9 5 4<br>♣ J 10 9 7 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ 9 6 5 4 3<br>♥ 10 6 3<br>♦ 3<br>♣ Q 8 6 2 |
| | ♠ A 8<br>♥ K Q 4<br>♦ A K Q J 8 6<br>♣ K 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 4♣ |
| Pass | 4♠ | Pass | 5♣ |
| Pass | 5♥ | Pass | 7NT |
| All Pass | | | |

7NT by North
Lead: ♥6

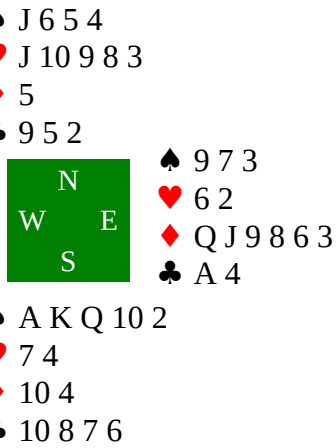
SOUTH opens 2♣.

NORTH should just respond 2NT, even with 11 points. The idea is to make a positive response (which forces the partnership to game level), and show extra strength later.

This time there is no need. SOUTH should bid 4♣ (Gerber), and NORTH answers 4♠ for two Aces.

Next SOUTH should ask for Kings, and when NORTH shows one King SOUTH should bid 7NT.

***Board 6***
West Deals
E-W Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2♣ | Pass | 3♦ | Pass |
| 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] | Pass |
| 6♦ | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♦ by East
Lead: ♠K

When WEST opens 2♣ EAST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But, because her suit is ♦s, she must jump to 3♦.

WEST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that EAST holds one Ace.

That's all EAST needs to know to bid 6♦.